

Think Like the Expert.

Position yourself to win.

Session 48 · Marketing Sweet · Sales Training

IN THIS TOOLKIT

- 01 The control-transfer question · reframed
- 02 Salesperson vs professional · the shift
- 03 Diagnose first · prescribe second
- 04 Confidence = preparation
- 05 Compounding · tiny decisions win
- 06 Daily reference card

01 · THE QUESTION THAT COSTS YOU

The Control-Transfer Question

Any question that can be answered "no" hands the client an exit.

THE QUESTION MOST REPS ASK

"Do you want to grow your business?"

Sounds reasonable. Isn't. You've just handed the client an easy exit — "no" — and left yourself nowhere to go. The conversation is now theirs to end.

→ **Momentum lost. Control transferred.**

▼ REFRAME ▼

WHAT AN EXPERT ASKS INSTEAD

"We've identified two ways we could continue improving your business."

- A slower, more economical approach.
- A more aggressive growth strategy.

"Which one do you think suits your business best?"

→ **NOT WHETHER GROWTH MATTERS. WHICH FORM OF IT.**

A completely different conversation, starting from a completely different premise.

THE PRINCIPLE

Not manipulation. Friction removal. Conversations that keep moving forward are how decisions get made.

02 · THE MENTAL SHIFT

Salesperson vs Professional

Stop asking the client to make the expert decisions.

SALESPERSON · ASKS THE CLIENT

- ✗ "What medicine would you like today?"
- ✗ "What part do you think needs replacing?"
- ✗ "What tax strategy should we use?"
- ✗ "Do you want a website?"
- ✗ "Would you like to grow?"

→ **ROLE COLLAPSES. VALUE EVAPORATES.**

PROFESSIONAL · DIAGNOSES, THEN RECOMMENDS

- ◆ Reviews the symptoms
- ◆ Runs the tests
- ◆ Understands the situation
- ◆ Names what's working / what isn't
- ◆ Recommends the right path

→ **THIS IS WHY CLIENTS CAME LOOKING.**

WHY PEOPLE COME TO PROFESSIONALS

Not because they already know the answer. Because they don't. The moment you start asking the client to make expert decisions, the value of the professional relationship collapses.

DIAGNOSE FIRST. PRESCRIBE SECOND. THE ORDER IS NOT OPTIONAL.

03 · THE PROFESSIONAL ORDER

Diagnose First. Prescribe Second.

Recommendation before understanding is guessing. Prospects can hear it.

1

ASK GOOD QUESTIONS

Not the closable-with-no kind. Open questions that let the client describe their actual situation.

2

REVIEW THE FACTS

Look at the data. Site, rankings, previous work, current pipeline. Show up knowing before you ask.

3

UNDERSTAND THE SITUATION

What's working? What isn't? Get the full picture before forming an opinion, let alone voicing one.

4

RECOMMEND CONFIDENTLY

Now — and only now — offer the recommendation. Anchored in what you've seen, not what you assumed.

WHY THE ORDER MATTERS

Prescribe-before-diagnose sounds like sales-talk. Diagnose-then-prescribe sounds like expertise. Prospects can hear the difference within your first two questions.

04 · THE MECHANISM

Confidence = Preparation

Not a personality trait. A by-product.

Preparation → Competence → Calm Confidence → Trust

Positive self-talk without preparation is a costume, not a state.

BEFORE THE CALL · 15-MINUTE CHECKLIST

- ✓ Account history — previous conversations, decisions, promises made.
- ✓ Current snapshot — site, rankings, spend, campaigns running now.
- ✓ The opportunities — three things I think could genuinely help this business.
- ✓ The challenges — two objections likely to land, and how I'll acknowledge each.
- ✓ One better question — what one question, if answered, would change everything?

"You don't need to rely on confidence. You rely on preparation. And preparation creates confidence naturally."

TRUSTED PROFESSIONALS AREN'T LOUD. THEY'RE COMPETENT — AND CALM.

05 · HOW EXPERTS ARE BUILT

Tiny Decisions Compound

THE OVERESTIMATE / UNDERESTIMATE LOOP

IN 1 WEEK

Overestimated. Feels like nothing changed. Doubt creeps in.

IN 5 YEARS

Underestimated. Compounding is undeniable in retrospect.

—
compounding

THE DAILY DECISIONS THAT COMPOUND

How well did you prepare? Did you research first? Ask one better question? Listen? Follow through?

COURAGE ISN'T THE ABSENCE OF FEAR

You'll feel inexperienced. You'll worry you don't know enough. That's normal — everyone feels that way. Successful people don't wait until they feel ready. They prepare. They practise. They learn. Then they move anyway.

YOUR CAREER IS SOMETHING YOU BUILD

One good decision won't change your life. Thousands of good decisions absolutely will. The choice — quiet, made repeatedly — is whether today is one of them.

06 · REFERENCE CARD

The Expert Position

Pin it. Read it before every client meeting.

SESSION 48 · DAILY CARD

Think like the expert.

NO MORE CONTROL-TRANSFER QUESTIONS

"Do you want to grow?" hands them an exit. Reframe as a choice between two forward paths.

STOP ASKING. START DIAGNOSING.

A doctor doesn't ask what medicine you want. Neither should you. Diagnose first — prescribe second.

UNDERSTAND BEFORE YOU TALK

Ask good questions. Review the facts. Then — and only then — recommend.

PREPARATION > CONFIDENCE

Confidence is a by-product. Do the 15-minute pre-call check. The state takes care of itself.

TRUSTED ISN'T LOUD

Great doctors, mechanics, advisers — none of them shout. They calmly explain. That's expertise.

TINY DECISIONS COMPOUND

Ask one better question. Listen properly. Follow through. Repeat. That's how experts get built.

TODAY'S CHALLENGE

Stop asking for permission. Act like the professional they came looking for.